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| 11 | <p>The International Space Station (ISS) orbits the Earth with uniform speed, above the Earth's atmosphere, at a constant height 420 km above the Earth's surface.</p> <p>What statement about the ISS is correct?</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|    | <p><b>A</b> There is no gravitational force on the ISS.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|    | <p><b>B</b> The resultant force on the ISS is in the direction it is moving.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|    | <p><b>C</b> The ISS is not accelerating.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|    | <p><b>D</b> The acceleration of the ISS is less than <math>9.81 \text{ m s}^{-2}</math>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|    | <p><b>Answer: D</b></p> <p>The gravitational force provides the centripetal force for the ISS to move in circular motion and the direction of the centripetal force is towards the centre of the Earth. Option A and B are incorrect.</p> <p>The acceleration is equal to the magnitude of the gravitational field strength <math>\left( \frac{GM_{\text{Earth}}}{r^2} \right)</math>.</p> <p>Since the acceleration on the Earth's surface is <math>9.81 \text{ m s}^{-2}</math> and the ISS is above the Earth's surface, its acceleration will be less than <math>9.81 \text{ m s}^{-2}</math>. Option D.</p> |

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| 12 | <p>A weather balloon, initially stationary on the ground, contains an ideal gas with an internal</p> |
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